

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 2)

Page 13 - Introductory (Part 4)

Q1. According to the text, a writer's work is largely determined by what?

- A. The amount of money he makes
- B. The moral and intellectual tendencies of his world
- C. The length of his life
- D. The geographical region he lives in

Answer: B

Q2. How is every writer regarded in relation to his time?

- A. As a product of his time
- B. As completely disconnected from his time
- C. As an anomaly of his time
- D. As an opponent of his time

Answer: A

Q3. What kind of influences belong to the sphere of books and scholarship?

- A. Political influences
- B. Purely literary influences
- C. Economic influences
- D. Societal influences

Answer: B

Q4. Which era's English literature was heavily influenced by enthusiasm for Greek and Latin classics?

- A. The Victorian era
- B. The Romantic era
- C. The Elizabethan era
- D. The Modernist era

Answer: C

Q5. Which movement revived interest in the art and literature of the middle ages?

- A. The Renaissance
- B. The Medieval Revival

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 2)

C. The French Revolution

D. Puritanism

Answer: B

Q6. Under the spell of which literature were English writers during the end of the seventeenth century?

A. Italian

B. French

C. German

D. Spanish

Answer: B

Q7. What factor, besides literary ones, can deeply affect the making of literature?

A. General life, politics, and society

B. The physical health of the author

C. The publisher's preferences

D. The amount of paper available

Answer: A

Q8. Which of the following is mentioned as an example of a non-literary movement that impacted general history and literature?

A. The invention of the printing press

B. The French Revolution

C. The discovery of America

D. The building of the Globe Theatre

Answer: B

Q9. What must we never think of a book as being?

A. Written for entertainment

B. Written outside the conditions of time and space

C. Written by a solitary author

D. Written with political intent

Answer: B

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 2)

Q10. How should we think of a book, according to the text?

- A. As an isolated work of fiction
- B. As a document solely for historians
- C. As the work of a man affected by the atmosphere and movements of his age
- D. As a completely independent creation

Answer: C

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 2)

Page 14 - Introductory (Part 5)

Q1. What is the principal object of a history of English literature?

- A. To memorize dates of publication
- B. To trace the progress of English literature through all its transformations
- C. To judge the moral character of authors
- D. To list the most popular books of each century

Answer: B

Q2. A history of English literature acts as a record of individual men AND what else?

- A. The number of copies sold
- B. The political laws of the time
- C. The personal and impersonal forces that shaped their work
- D. The financial success of their publications

Answer: C

Q3. Why does a history of English literature have a national character?

- A. Because every man belongs to his race and age, expressing its spirit
- B. Because it is funded by the government
- C. Because all writers must be born in England
- D. Because literature is only read by the nation's citizens

Answer: A

Q4. How is ordinary English history described in comparison to its literature?

- A. Ordinary history is its autobiography, literature is its biography
- B. Ordinary history is its fiction, literature is its reality
- C. Ordinary history is its biography, literature is its autobiography
- D. Ordinary history is its economy, literature is its politics

Answer: C

Q5. What does the story of ordinary English history primarily contain?

- A. Intellectual and moral development
- B. Actions and practical achievements

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 2)

C. Poetry and drama

D. Literary criticism

Answer: B

Q6. What does English literature tell the story of?

A. Military conquests

B. Intellectual and moral development

C. Economic trade

D. Scientific discoveries

Answer: B

Q7. By following the history of our literature, what do we come into direct contact with?

A. The exact physical appearance of our ancestors

B. The motive forces of the inner life of each generation

C. The architectural designs of the past

D. The legal codes of previous centuries

Answer: B

Q8. What can we learn at first hand about a past generation by studying its literature?

A. How they built their houses

B. What they looked like

C. What standards of conduct and taste governed them

D. What agricultural techniques they used

Answer: C

Q9. How should we think of English literature in chronological study?

A. As a collection of random stories

B. As a static set of rules

C. As the progressive revelation of the mind and spirit of the English people

D. As a series of unrelated individual achievements

Answer: C

Q10. What does the spirit of an author's race and age find through him?

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 2)

- A. Complete rejection
- B. Financial gain
- C. Expression
- D. Erasure

Answer: C

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 2)

Page 15 - Introductory (Part 6)

Q1. Why is the history of English literature always divided into periods?

- A. Because books were only published in certain years
- B. Because authors demanded it
- C. Primarily as a matter of convenience for study
- D. Because different languages were spoken in each period

Answer: C

Q2. What defines a 'period' in the context of literature?

- A. Exactly one hundred years
- B. The lifespan of a single author
- C. A length of time during which a particular kind of taste prevails
- D. The reign of a single monarch

Answer: C

Q3. What happens when there is a decisive change of taste?

- A. A period comes to a close while another opens
- B. Literature stops being produced
- C. All previous books are destroyed
- D. Authors stop writing completely

Answer: A

Q4. What must we be on guard against when treating these literary periods?

- A. Remembering the dates too exactly
- B. Treating them as rigorously fixed and self-contained
- C. Studying them too closely
- D. Associating them with history

Answer: B

Q5. How does history recognize endings and beginnings?

- A. It recognizes only absolute endings
- B. It recognizes only absolute beginnings

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 2)

- C. It recognizes only a continuous flow, not absolute endings and beginnings
- D. It recognizes them perfectly by century marks

Answer: C

Q6. Why is the division of periods sometimes considered arbitrary?

- A. Because authors often lived in multiple countries
- B. Because chronological age overlaps, as seen with Dryden and Milton
- C. Because all authors write exactly the same way
- D. Because time is an illusion

Answer: B

Q7. Why are literary periods practically of utmost value?

- A. They help concentrate attention on the most important things in each stage
- B. They make it easy to skip certain centuries
- C. They ensure we only read the best authors
- D. They help memorize dates faster

Answer: A

Q8. What is a common method of labeling literary periods, which the author decides against?

- A. By the dominant religion
- B. By epithets derived from history (e.g., Elizabethan Age)
- C. By the number of books published
- D. By the geographic location

Answer: B

Q9. How does the author purpose to designate each period?

- A. By the ruling monarch
- B. By the name of its most characteristic and representative writer
- C. By century
- D. By the most popular book

Answer: B

Q10. Which of the following is NOT listed as one of the large divisions of study in the text?

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 2)

- A. The Age of Shakespeare
- B. The Age of Milton
- C. The Age of Dickens
- D. The Age of Pope

Answer: C